



Good THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church
→ we seek we serve we celebrate

AUTUMN 2026

Bringing Joy!

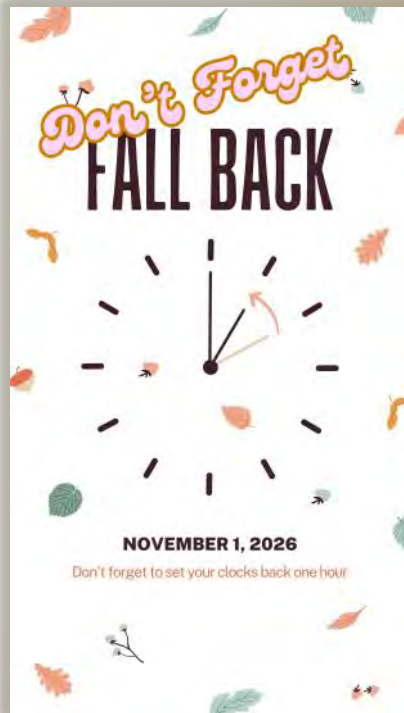
We will continue our series on how to Bring Joy to ourselves and our communities through the engagement of spiritual practices. In addition, we'll celebrate World Communion Sunday on Oct. 4, All Saints Day on Nov. 1, and Advent begins on Nov. 29.

Time Change

It will soon be time to fall back and gain that hour we lost in the spring. Set your clocks back one hour before attending worship on Sunday, Nov. 1

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Oct. 4

World Communion Sunday
Exodus 20:1-4, 7-9, 12-20
"Bring Joy Through Worship"

Oct. 11

Matthew 22:1-14
"Bring Joy with an Open Table"

Oct. 18

Deuteronomy 34:1-12
"Bring Joy by Practicing Hope"

Oct. 25

Jason Emrick preaching

Nov. 1

Communion
All Saints Sunday
Matthew 5:1-12
"Bring Joy Through Blessings"

Nov. 8

"Bring Joy by Encouraging One Another"
1 Thessalonians 5:1-11

Nov. 15

Psalms 78:1-7
"Bring Joy By Knowing the Story"

Nov. 22

Matthew 25:31-46
"Bring Joy by Loving Our Neighbor"

Tuesday, Nov. 24

Thanksgiving Service
7:00 Ecumenical Thanksgiving Service at St. Peder's with Bethel Lutheran

Nov. 29

1st Sunday of Advent/Communion
Psalm 80:1-7, 17-19; Isaiah 64:1-9
"Until the Dawn Cry Out"



**United
Women
in Faith**

United Women in Faith

Schools' are going strong, the temps are dropping, the leaves are being blown so Fall must be here. Time to prepare for our church's annual Holiday Bazaar. Start making, baking, sewing, carving, arranging those crafts you would like to sell at our annual Holiday Bazaar! It will be Sat., Nov. 14 from 9:00-2:00 with vendor tables to rent, food to eat, a Granny's Attic with jewelry and great valuable stuff. We can always use volunteers so be ready to volunteer! Set up and food prep is the day before, Nov. 13.

If you are interested in being a vendor this year, which is a great way to meet our community while you are making some money from the sales of something handmade and crafted :(mittens, books, jewelry, furniture, shoes, candy, etc.), complete the following information and get it to Maureen Trepp at maureentrepp@gmail.com:

Name_____

Email_____

Cell phone:_____

What I will be selling:_____

Table Size and Number of tables: Long 8'(\$25)____Short 6' (\$15)____

Setting up my sales (pick one):

Friday, Nov.13 before 6:30_____Morning of 11/14, open at 7:30_____

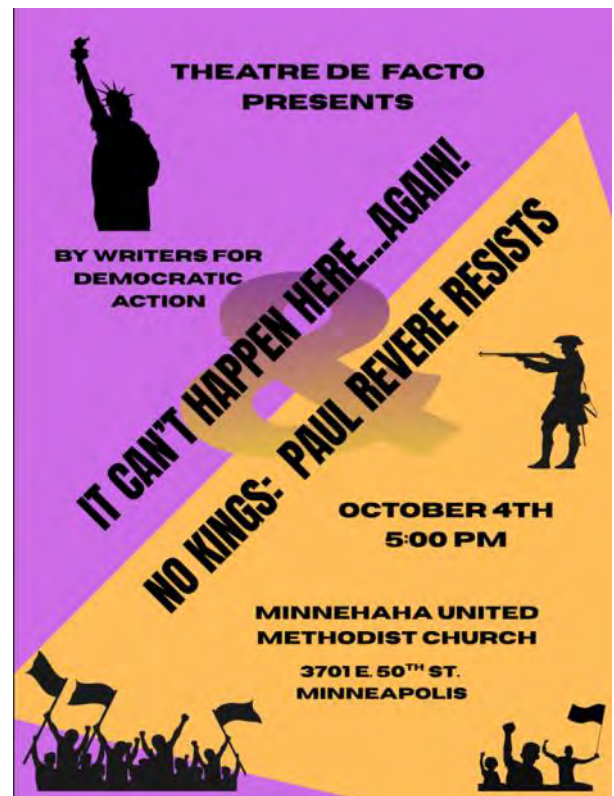
Other requests: (electricity, wall space, extra chairs, chairs, etc.)_____

(Continued on page 3)

New members the Payseur Family!



Pack 3001 is hosting a Halloween Party on October 30th! We will have carnival-style games, some concessions for sale, and a lightly spooky haunted hallway, if you dare to enter. All are welcome to join in the fun!





(Continued from page 2)

You may pay your rental fee the day of the Bazaar. Any questions? Contact Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520.

Our Holiday Bazaar, on Nov. 14 from 9:00 a.m.- 2:00 p.m. is an event you really will enjoy including the great food to eat, the sale items and being with your church friends. We can always use help on either Nov. 13 during the day or at the Bazaar so please contact Margaret Rawson at 612-806-6630 if you wish to volunteer.

We continue to serve meals at the new Simpson Shelter during the last week of the month. It only takes 6 of us to prep meals under the direction of the chef employed by Simpson. Upcoming dates are Sept. 28, Oct. 27, Nov. 23 and Dec. 28. If you are interested in helping, we need to preregister and we begin to serve at 5:00. Please contact Maureen Trepp at 612-387-2520

My wish is for you to savor the day and be good to yourself.

Peace, Maureen Trepp, *UWF President*



SAVE THE DATE

Christmas Pageant on Sunday, Dec. 13 at 4:00 pm

*Rehearsal on Wednesday, Dec. 9

SAVE THE DATE

Youth Ski Trip to Spirit Mountain, Duluth on January 9-10

Confirmation Class of 2026



Confirmation of Lucas Messier, Hazel Schlosser, and Sean Kennedy-Heldt



Confirmation of Sylvia Febr



HALLOWEEN COSTUME PARADE

**Saturday, Oct. 31
10 am**

Meet in the sideyard at 9:45am

**We'll parade to Nokomis Square &
back collecting treats along the route!**



Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Halloween Costume Parade

Come in your Halloween costume and walk in the parade! We'll meet in the side yard at 9:45 am, line up along the sidewalk to begin the parade at 10 am. We'll walk down to Nokomis Square courtyard (collecting treats along the way) and then loop back to church for hot apple cider.

*Youth and adults can also join the fun! Wear your costume and help handout candy along the route. Meet inside the church doors at 9:45 am to get your bucket of candy.

MONTH OF NOVEMBER



FOOD DRIVE

**CHILDREN AND YOUTH
WILL BE COLLECTING NON-PERISHABLE FOOD
FOR THE MINNEHAHA FOOD SHELF
IN NEED OF:**

- **HEARTY SOUPS***
- **CANNED FRUIT***
- **ONE-DISH MEALS***
- **1-LB. BAGS OF RICE**
- **PERSONAL CARE ITEMS**

***CANNED ITEMS WITH POP-TOPS, PLEASE.**

**IN RECOGNITION OF THANKSGIVING, WE WILL
PRESENT AND BLESS THE COLLECTED FOOD IN
WORSHIP ON SUNDAY, NOV. 22
(SEE COLLECTION BIN IN THE NARTHEX)**

October Youth Group

Oct. 4 • Decorate & Bake Cookies
• Attend performance of
"It Can't Happen Here...
Again" & "No Kings: Paul
Revere Resists"
~Special Time: 4:00-6:00 pm

Oct. 11 Granny IRL
(church-friendly version)

Oct. 18 No Youth Group (MEA)

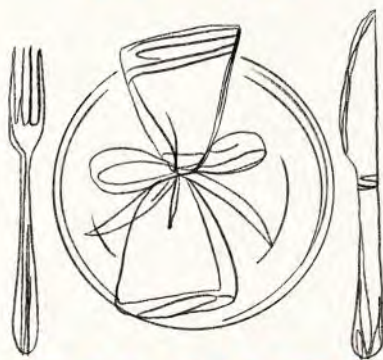
Oct. 25 Halloween Costume Party
• Pumpkin Carving
• Costume Contest

Youth Group

Youth (6th-12th grade) gather each Sunday from 4:00-5:30 pm for snacks, games, and activities!

MINNEHAHA CHURCH

WEDNESDAY NIGHT DINNER



5:30-6:15 PM

\$5/person; \$20/family

Come enjoy good food & great conversations each week!

Wednesday Night Dinners

Everyone is invited to this weekly meal from 5:30-6:15 pm in Fellowship Hall. Enjoy good food and conversation!



Stewardship

Our Stewardship Campaign (raising pledges to fund our 2027 Operating Budget) will begin a month earlier this year, on Oct. 11. Watch for announcements about how you can Vote for Minnehaha! with your pledges. Pledge cards will be mailed out the first week of November.

Harvest Dinner and Variety Show

Our Annual Harvest Dinner and Variety Show will be on Saturday, Nov. 7! Save the date, and begin to plan your bit for the variety show. Do you sing? Play an instrument? Recite poetry? Have a skit? Learning to tap dance? All of those and more are welcome at our fun and definitely not professional variety show. Plan to come at 4:30 for the show and 6:00 for dinner. If you do have something you'd like to do at the Variety Show, please contact Julia Cook. The Harvest Dinner will be a multi-course dinner featuring beef brisket with an enticing vegetarian option. This is one of the 2 major fundraisers for the church, so please plan to come, and invite friends to join you as well.

Minnehaha Playgroup

Babies and toddlers with their caregivers are invited to stop by on Thursday mornings for a time of play and community. Playgroup meet in the 2nd floor nursery and preschool room. Follow the "Minnehaha Playgroup 2026-2027" group on Facebook for more information.

Wednesday Night Childcare

There is supervised childcare from 6:00-7:15 pm in the gym and nursery.



Newcomer Classes

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Wednesday, September 30. Please join us at 5:15 p.m., just prior to the Wednesday night dinner at in the fellowship hall (dinner is at 5:30). Your meal is on us, and we'll have a table set aside for the class. Just to give us an idea of numbers, please RSVP to becky@minnehaha.org.

Church Conference

Church Conference is the official word we use for an all-church meeting. We need to have a church conference sometime in November to set the salaries for salaries for Jean Elliott and Becky Sechrist. We do this before the formal budget is adopted because the denomination requires that all clergy salaries be set by December 1 so that the numbers can be processed by the pensions people. If our budgeting process prompts a change in salary, then we can make a correction and vote on it the same time we vote on the budget, sending in amended paperwork at that time. This year, we will be holding this meeting as part of a cluster with other United Methodist congregations in our area. We will gather on Sunday, Nov. 23 at 5:00 in our building, hear some words from our Conference Superintendent, Rev. Gordon Deuel, and then do the work that we need to together. Anyone can attend, and anyone with full membership can vote.

All-Church Service Project

Following the worship service, everyone is invited to gather in the narthex to decorate birthday bags and assemble 48 birthday kits! These birthday kits will be donated to VEAP.

*No Sunday School classes



ADVENT FEST SUNDAY, NOV. 22

FOLLOWING 9:30 AM WORSHIP

- **MAKE A FAMILY ADVENT WREATH**
- **MAKE CHRISTMAS TREE ORNAMENTS**
- **COLOR AN ADVENT MURAL**
- **CHILDREN'S SECRET GIFT WORKSHOP**



Advent Fest

Following the worship service, everyone is invited to gather in Fellowship Hall to prepare for Advent:

- Make a family Advent wreath
- Create Christmas tree ornaments (adults)
- Color Advent mural
- Children's Secret Gift Shop - kids can shop for Christmas gifts for parents, neighbors and friends. (All gifts are \$1.00)

*No Sunday School classes

Advent Bible Study

Join Rev. Gail Alexander and the people at Epworth UMC for a combined Advent Study this year! "On the Way to Bethlehem" follows the long journey to Christmas. The story begins in Rome with a decree issued from the seat of worldly power for a census, setting into motion events leading to the birth of the Savior of the world in a town that represents the very opposite of worldly power, Bethlehem. Author Rob Fuquay (senior pastor at St. Luke's UMC in Indianapolis) provides insight into the geographical and historical significance of Rome, Jerusalem, Nazareth, and Bethlehem, along with the important characters through whom the Christmas drama unfolds. The class will be offered multiple times so you can choose the time that fits your schedule the best.

Week 1: Tues. Nov. 17 10:00 a.m. at Minnehaha
Tues. Nov. 17 6:30 p.m. at Minnehaha
Wed. Nov. 18 5:15 at Epworth (3207 37th Ave. S)

Week 2: Tues. Dec. 1 10:00 a.m. at Minnehaha
Tues. Dec. 1 6:30 p.m. at Minnehaha
Wed. Dec. 2 5:15 at Epworth

Week 3: Tues. Dec. 8 10:00 a.m. at Minnehaha
Tues. Dec. 8 6:30 p.m. at Minnehaha
Wed. Dec. 9 5:15 at Epworth

Week 4: Tues. Dec. 15 10:00 a.m. at Minnehaha
Tues. Dec. 15 6:30 p.m. at Minnehaha
Wed. Dec. 16 5:15 at Epworth

Advent Devotionals and Calendars

Advent, the season of preparation for Christmas, begins on November 29. We are following a theme of "Until the Dawn" and have Advent calendars for families with children, and an Advent Devotional for every household. You can pick up either/both of these items at the church beginning mid-November. Let us know if you cannot make it to church and would like us to mail you a devotional and/or calendar.

Online Advent Study with the Bishop

Join Bishop Lanette for an online Advent study including United Methodists from across Minnesota and the Dakotas. The theme is "When Hope Is Born: An Advent Study in the Theology of Midwifery" and no book or pre-reading is necessary. The study will be offered on Monday evenings, Nov. 30, Dec. 7, 14, and 21 from 7-8:15. A zoom link will be in the enews closer to the end of November.

Artificial Intelligence & United Methodist Church's Social Principles

Join us for an adult faith formation series on Pope Leo XIV's encyclical on AI, Magnifica Humanitatis! Led by John Davis on Sunday mornings from 10:45-11:30 a.m. Each week, we'll dive into a single chapter, exploring human dignity, digital ethics, the common good, and remaining profoundly human in a tech-driven world. Discover how the United Methodist Church's Social Principles guide our relationship with modern technology.

All Saints Sunday

We will be celebrating All Saints Sunday on November 1, reading the names of all the members of the congregation who have died since the last All Saints Sunday, remembering their lives and their ministry among us. If you know of any family members or good friends of people who have died in the last year, please be sure to extend an invitation to them to join us for worship that day.

Bible Study: Confirmation for Adults

You are welcome to join the Bible Study, "Confirmation for Adults" anytime this fall. We meet on Monday evenings at 6:30 p.m. (through Nov. 9) and there will be a hybrid option as well with a link in the enews each week. Classes don't require any preparation, and we are currently learning about a different set of books in the Bible each week.

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taize service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us on Oct. 9 and Nov. 13 for a time of renewal. The service is also livestreamed, so you can worship through your screen, wherever you are, either in real time or anytime after.



Thanksgiving Eve Eve Worship

This year's ecumenical Thanksgiving service will be on **Tuesday**, Nov. 24 at 7:00 at Holy Cross Lutheran (1720 E. Minnehaha Parkway). There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service at 6:00. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the *night before* the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with gratitude for all that God has given us.





MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month; join us on October 24 for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! You can volunteer anytime between 7:00 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up around 7:00, serve the food starting around 8:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30.

Special Note regarding November & December

MinneHarvest: Because of how Thanksgiving and Christmas affect our delivery schedule, MinneHarvest will be one week earlier in both November and December – November 21 and December 19.

SNAP Sunday

SNAP (Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, formerly food stamps) is changing. New eligibility rules mean the Minnesota Department of Children, Youth and Families expects roughly a third of the state's SNAP recipients to lose their benefits altogether, while those who remain enrolled will receive less help each month.

This isn't an abstract policy shift — it's about our neighbors. Right now, 100,238 people in Hennepin County rely on SNAP to help feed their families. As benefits shrink, many will turn to food shelves like Minnehaha Food Shelf to fill the gap. That's why our seven sponsoring congregations are joining together on Sunday, October 11 for "SNAP Sunday" — a day of giving to help us meet a goal of \$4,000, the average weekly cost of keeping our shelves stocked with fresh, nutritious food. You can help by giving through a special offering that day, or anytime, at our secure online donation page:

<https://bit.ly/3JCzVDT>

Pasta Dinner

Thursday October 22nd

5:30-7:30

New Branches
5011 31st Ave So.
Minneapolis

Minnehaha Food Shelf
Minneapolis

FAT LORENZO'S
Catering

****Prizes & Gift Baskets Drawing**

Early Bird Tickets
\$32 / \$37 10/17-10/21
Kids under 5 eat **FREE**.
Advanced Tickets Required

Scan for tickets



**Fundraising
Benefit for
Minnehaha
Food Shelf**

TOTAL CONTRIBUTIONS FOR 2026



Through August, we're \$12,673 short of our goal. Let's see if we can pick it up in September.

Summer is always a challenge. We can catch up.

OUR AUGUST 2026 CONTRIBUTIONS ARE:
\$30,017

TOTAL CONTRIBUTIONS GOAL FOR 2026:
\$502,810

We need to average \$41,901 each month to make our goal.



We're at \$322,535...short by \$12,673.

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

4 Easy Ways to Donate to Minnehaha UMC

There are many ways to give to the church: Volunteer, support our food ministries or other missions, or with cash, check, or electronically. A monthly contribution through your bank (EFT) makes it easier for us to budget for the year, and there's just a small added fee. But do whatever works best for you. Know that the church also accepts gifts of stocks, bonds, and other securities, as well as real estate and more. Contributing through a Donor Advised Fund (DAF) or Qualified Charitable Distribution (QCD) are other options. Also consider making Minnehaha UMC a beneficiary in your will or trust. If you need more information on gifting to Minnehaha United Methodist Church, contact the church treasurer or the pastor. Thank you!

Cash		No Fee
Check		No Fee
EFT (Electronic Funds Transfer) via UMC		0.45% Fee
PayPal		3.5% Fee

Voting in “Unprecedented” Times



I don't know about you, but I am tired of hearing every news story include the word, “unprecedented.” It raises my anxiety, and makes me want to turn off the news, or pull the covers over my head, or move someplace very remote where I can just do my own thing and not worry about everyone else. Or all three. The problem, of course, is that I can't. I don't mean that I really can't, because I certainly could. But, I can't. I can't because with every passage in the Bible that I read, each hymn that I sing, I realize that God is calling me into this very time. I am here, now, and I am called to be a witness for love and grace and mercy here and now. It would be very hard to be that witness if my voice is muffled under the covers, I don't encounter anyone, or I am unaware of what is happening

around me. And I don't just mean God is calling me; I think God is calling all of us. The great thing about community is that each of us can take a “remote island” or “no news today” or “I'm sleeping in” moment to regroup and reset because others are there to continue to do the work God calls us to. We might be living in unprecedented times, but the reality is that every time is unprecedented. Even if we always do the same thing, we are never the same people doing it. As much as we might like it, we cannot be static as a people. Every thing changes us, even repetition. As we embody the spiritual practices we are learning this fall, we become different people. And, hopefully, we become more attuned to how God is calling to us, and what God is calling us to.

I firmly believe God calls us to participate to whatever extent we can in this world, and in the communities we are in. This does include voting, for those of us who are citizens and 18 or older. With the privilege to vote also comes the responsibility to know something about the issues of our day. There is information all over the church (and all over our city) on how to make sure you are registered, how to register if you are not, and how to get a sample ballot so you can research the candidates and the issues. Please don't count on everyone else to vote for you. This is that one thing where each of us actually does need to participate. If you need help understanding the issues, a ride to your polling place, help getting the information, please reach out to someone else – there are people all around you who can help you participate in your community.

We will also be opening the sanctuary the evening before the election for a time of prayer and reflection. If you need a quiet place, please feel free to come over to the church and spend some time praying for the election, the candidates, and for your own wisdom in casting a vote.

We are always living in unprecedented times; take this particular unprecedented moment to live out your faith by participating in our political system. Your community relies on it.

With Joy,

Becky



Baptism of Hank O'Sheridan



Baptism of Greta Nelson



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10/26

Visit us online!
www.minnehaha.org

Pictures from our Pet Blessing

